

Day 1 troubleshooting

Walk the room with this page. Most failures are PATH, the distro Go package, or GitHub login.

What they see	Likely cause	What you do
<code>go: command not found</code>	PATH not loaded, or they used a new terminal after edit	<code>source ~/.bashrc</code> or close terminal and open again. <code>echo \$PATH</code> should contain <code>/usr/local/go/bin</code> . which <code>go</code>
<code>go version</code> is 1.18 / 1.21 / <code>gccgo</code>	<code>apt install golang-go</code>	<code>sudo apt remove golang-go gccgo-go</code> then install from go.dev. which <code>go</code> must be <code>/usr/local/go/bin/go</code>
<code>wget</code> 403 / hang	lab firewall	USB tarball or browser download into <code>~/Downloads</code>
Permission denied on <code>/usr/local/go</code>	forgot <code>sudo</code>	repeat <code>sudo rm</code> / <code>sudo tar</code>
VS Code has no format on save	settings not saved, or folder not opened	Open folder <code>~/epic-go/hello</code> , not a single file. Paste <code>vscode-settings.json</code> . Status bar should say Go
Could not import <code>fmt</code> / <code>gopls</code> red squiggles	tools not installed	Command Palette → Go: Install/Update Tools
<code>undefined: fmt.Println</code>	lowercase <code>p</code>	Teaching moment: exported names are Capitalised . <code>Println</code>
<code>go build</code> / <code>go run</code> : <code>package . is not in std</code> or module errors	they ran <code>go build</code> . with no <code>go.mod</code>	Today: <code>go run hello.go</code> and <code>go build -o hello hello.go</code> only
<code>./hello: No such file</code>	<code>go build</code> failed or they are in another directory	<code>ls; cd ~/epic-go/hello</code>
Git: <code>Please tell me who you are</code>	no identity	<code>git config --global user.name</code> and <code>user.email</code>
<code>git push</code> 403 / auth	HTTPS without token	GitHub → Settings → Developer settings → PAT, or <code>gh auth login</code>

What they see	Likely cause	What you do
failed to push unrelated histories	they created a README on GitHub	empty repo on GitHub, no README, no .gitignore on the website
Binary on GitHub (hello several MB)	.gitignore missing	add hello to .gitignore, git rm -- cached hello, commit, push
Windows: works in Ubuntu, go missing in PowerShell	expected	Stay in Ubuntu (WSL) for all course commands
Dual-boot: project on D:\	later weeks	Day 1 keep ~/epic-go on the Linux home , not the Windows NTFS drive

Nuclear reinstall (Ubuntu)

```
sudo rm -rf /usr/local/go
sudo tar -C /usr/local -xzf ~/Downloads/go1.25.0.linux-amd64.tar.gz
export PATH=/usr/local/go/bin:$PATH
go version
```

Add PATH to ~/.bashrc if it is not already there.